

Daikin DP3GM3006031 vs Carrier 48NL-B300603 vs Tempstar PGB430060K000B

2.5-ton, 60,000 Btuh single-packaged gas/electric. Prepared Mon 2026-09-21 for Jeff Loewen. **Every Daikin number below was read this session out of Daikin's own PDFs** — spec sheet SS-DP3GM/DP3UM-R32 rev 11/24, warranty certificate PWDPKGETYURG rev 04/2025, install manual IM-IOD-3033. Not from a dealer page, not from memory. Carrier and Tempstar rows carry over from the 09-17 two-way comparison, which read both 39-page product-data books side by side.

Read this first — these are not the same kind of thing. The Carrier and the Tempstar are **installed bids**: a contractor's price with duct work, the twist fix, commissioning and a labour warranty wrapped around the box. The Daikin is a **unit bought over the counter at D.T. McCall & Sons**, with the install, the pad, the plenums and all labour still on your side of the ledger. **Comparing \$4,600 to \$11,400 is not a comparison.** What this sheet does is say what the Daikin box actually is, what it costs beyond the sticker, and the three places it does not match the machine you already specced.

The machine, side by side

Item	Daikin DP3GM3006031	Carrier 48NL-B300603	Tempstar PGB430060K000B
Heat exchanger (<i>your deal breaker</i>)	Stainless steel, STANDARD — "Heavy-duty stainless-steel heat exchanger", Standard Features p1 MET	Stainless "Turbo-tubular"	Stainless "Turbo-tubular"
Compressor brand	COPELAND SCROLL — CONFIRMED IN WRITING by the selling dealer. D.T. McCall & Sons proposal, 2026-09-21: "This unit has a Copeland Scroll Compressor and a Stainless Steel heat exchanger." No Daikin spec sheet names a compressor brand , so the dealer's written proposal is the only source that answers this ANSWERED	Scroll	Scroll
Cabinet W × D × H	47 × 51 × 32 in (34 ⁵ / ₈ over flange) — Daikin dimension table, row DP3*M30***31 PAD FAIL	Drawing only in the product data, no text table. The existing pad carries the old Nordyne at 47.5 in.	
Duct openings	Supply 16×16, return 16×16 — new plenums both sides; nothing on the current drawing carries over REWORK	13.44×14.32 side / 14.02×11.49 btm	same as Carrier
EER2 (<i>what you pay in July</i>)	10.6 LOWER	11.05	11.05
Sound	76 dB LOUDER	73 dBA	73 dBA
Cooling / SEER2	28,600 Btu/h · 13.4 SEER2	28,800 · 13.4	28,800 · 13.4
Gas in / out · AFUE	60,000 / 48,600 · 81%	60,000 / 49,000 · 81%	60,000 / 49,000 · 81%
Refrigerant	R-32, 57 oz (3.56 lb) · A2L	R-454B, 4.85 lb · A2L	R-454B, 4.85 lb · A2L
Evaporator coil	All-aluminum, 4.35 ft², 3 row	All-aluminum, 3.7 ft², 3 row	same
Blower	ECM, 5-speed, ½ hp	ECM ½ hp	same
MCA / max breaker	21.2 A / 30 A — check the existing circuit	25 A	25 A

Operating weight	370–380 lb	348 lb	348 lb
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The model number, and the one-digit trap. Quote **DP3GM3006031** at the counter. The **11th character must be a 3** — that is R-32, the current legal refrigerant. A **4** in that position (DP3GM3006041) is the old **R-410A** unit, which is no longer installable, and wholesalers are still listing those. Your own file already flagged this class of trap on 08-31: *"a cheap R-410A package unit online is a TRAP — it is no longer legally installable."*

The warranty — and whether it survives buying it yourself

Read verbatim this session out of **Daikin LIMITED WARRANTY, Part No. PWDPKGETYURG rev 04/2025**, which names **"Models: DP14GM, DP14UM, DP3GM, DP3UM"** — so it is the right certificate for this unit.

THE HEADLINE, AND IT IS GOOD NEWS: an over-the-counter purchase does not void the warranty.

The only installer-related exclusion in the entire certificate reads, word for word:

"Units that are ordered over the Internet, by telephone, or by other electronic means unless the unit is installed by a dealer adhering to all applicable federal, state, and local codes, policies, and licensing requirements."

The trigger is the ORDER CHANNEL, not who holds the wrench. A walk-in purchase at a counter in Carthage is not internet, not telephone, and not "other electronic means" — so on the plain text of the certificate **that exclusion never fires**, and the unit carries full warranty no matter who sets it. **There is no clause anywhere requiring a licensed or factory-authorized installer, and no "unauthorized reseller" clause.**

This corrects our own record. ac_unit_and_ductwork_2026-08-31.md says: *"GOODMAN'S WARRANTY HAS NO '(or certified)' ESCAPE HATCH ... Choosing Goodman therefore KILLS the friend-labour path outright."* **That was over-stated.** The Daikin certificate, verified directly, conditions nothing on the installer for an in-person purchase. **Caveat, stated plainly: the research reports Goodman's certificate carries the identical sentence, but the document verified here was Daikin's, not Goodman's.** The 08-31 note should be amended, not deleted.

Warranty term	Daikin DP3GM (<i>verified verbatim</i>)	Carrier 48NL	Tempstar PGB4
Registration deadline	60 days — "properly registered online within 60 days after the installation date" TIGHTER	90 days	90 days
Parts, registered	12 YEARS — best of the three BEST	10 yr	10 yr
Parts, NOT registered	5 years	5 yr	5 yr
Heat exchanger	20 years fully covered, then "after the first 20 YEARS ... but within the first 99 YEARS ... Daikin will furnish a replacement heat exchanger without charge, once only " NOT LIFETIME	Lifetime registered, else 20 yr	Lifetime registered, else 20 yr
Compressor	No separate term — falls under "all other parts"	10 yr	10 yr
Whole-unit replacement	None in the certificate	None	3-yr "No Hassle" one-time whole-unit replacement
Who returns a failed part	"To receive a replacement part, a licensed contractor must bring the failed part to a Daikin distributor." You cannot walk it to the counter yourself — a real friction cost over 12 years FRICTION	Same pattern on both	
The exclusion that still bites	"Damage or repairs required as a consequence of faulty installation or application." On all three units . A bad set gets denied on cause, not on who installed it — which is the real risk in a self-install, not the paperwork.		

One conflict inside Daikin's own paperwork, found this session. The **spec sheet** markets *"Lifetime Heat Exchanger Warranty (good for as long as you own your home), and 12-year Parts Limited Warranty"*. The **certificate** says 20 years plus **one** free replacement out to 99. Those are not the same promise. The certificate is

the controlling document, so treat it as **20 years + one replacement**, not lifetime. **Do not rely on the brochure wording.**

What a self-install actually involves (A2L)

From Daikin's own installation manual **IM-IOD-3033**. Much of this applies to the Carrier and Tempstar too — **R-454B is also an A2L refrigerant**.

The good news: a straight swap needs no refrigerant work on the new unit. A packaged unit is a sealed, self-contained circuit and ships factory-charged. No brazing, no line set, no evacuation, no charging — so **EPA 608 certification is not required to set the new box**, because the circuit is never opened. **But recovering the refrigerant out of the old Nordyne before it is hauled off does require EPA 608** and proper recovery gear. That part is a certified-tech job regardless of who installs the new one.

- Three A2L requirements that are easy to miss — and one of them hits the Carrier and Tempstar bids too.**
- **The unit must never be left unpowered.** "UNIT MUST BE POWERED EXCEPT FOR SERVICE" — it carries a powered refrigerant leak-detection and mitigation system that runs the blower to purge. **No seasonal breaker-off.**
 - **THE DUCT UV LIGHT.** "AUXILIARY DEVICES WHICH MAY BE A POTENTIAL IGNITION SOURCE SHALL NOT BE INSTALLED IN THE DUCT WORK. EXAMPLES ... ARE HOT SURFACES ... AND **ELECTRIC SWITCHING DEVICES,**" and "ONLY AUXILIARY DEVICES APPROVED BY THE APPLIANCE MANUFACTURER ... SHALL BE INSTALLED IN CONNECTING DUCTWORK." **The owner-supplied REKO R2000 UV unit is an electrical device in the duct, and both Peters and Goodlettsville have agreed to install it free.** Because R-454B is A2L as well, **this needs checking on whichever unit is bought — it is not a Daikin-only issue.**
 - **Charge is tied to airflow.** "this charge is based on 325 CFM per ton and minimum ESP ... When air quantity or ESP is different than above, the refrigerant charge must be adjusted." If the measured static lands outside the band, somebody has to touch the charge — and that is back into certified refrigerant work.

Job	What it takes on the Daikin
Pad	PAVERS — \$77.88, decided 2026-09-21. Six Pavestone Avant XL 24×24×2 (model 11019457, \$12.98 ea, 70 in stock at Hendersonville) laid 2 wide × 3 deep = 48×72 on compacted gravel. Width runs 48 in against the cabinet's 47 in — tight, but the unit bears on its perimeter base. Beats the 52×52 plastic pad (\$269.49 Home Depot / \$267.99 Amazon) by \$191. Rejected: poured pad ~\$100–\$120 all in (10–12 bags Quikrete 80 lb @ \$6.47 plus forms and mesh).
Plenums	Both transitions re-fabricated to 16×16. Every plenum dimension on the duct drawing is sized for the Carrier/Blueridge cabinet and does not carry over.
Gas	Per NFPA 54 / ANSI Z223.1, leak-checked, manifold pressure set. White House needs no permit for a gas like-for-like change-out (confirmed 09-17).
Electrical	208/230 V 1-ph. Max breaker 30 A against 25 A on the Carrier — verify existing wire gauge and breaker.
Condensate	¾ in NPT female, trapped and pitched.
Registration	Within 60 days or it drops to 20 yr HX / 5 yr parts.

Money, and what to ask at the counter

PRICED 2026-09-21 — a real written quote, not an estimate. D.T. McCall & Sons, Carthage (101 Water Street · (615) 588-3017 · hvac@dtmccalls.com), from **Cindy Lourcey**: **"Daikin, 2.5 Ton, Gas Package Unit, R32 Refrigerant, 14 SEER, 60k btu heat. This unit has a Copeland Scroll Compressor and a Stainless Steel heat exchanger. This unit has a 12 year parts warranty IF you register it upon installation. TOTAL FOR THIS UNIT, OUT THE DOOR, tax already included \$4,600.00"** — *unit only, no installation. Two in stock.*

✔ **Three of her claims check out against the documents read here:** R-32 ✓ · stainless heat exchanger ✓ (Standard Features, spec sheet p1) · 12-year parts on registration ✓ (certificate, 60-day deadline). Her **"14 SEER" is the marketing number — the rating is 13.4 SEER2**, exactly as Goodlettsville's quote said "14 seer" for a 13.4 SEER2 Tempstar. ⚠ **Still get the full model number on the receipt** — the proposal does not carry one, and registration needs it.

For reference: the identical Goodman-badged chassis lists online at **\$4,543** (HVACDirect) and **\$4,576** (SkipTheWarehouse), so \$4,600 tax-in for the Daikin badge — which carries the stainless exchanger and the longer parts term — is consistent.

PRICED — the exact size, found in the browser. The Daikin has **16×16 openings on BOTH supply and return**, so the job needs **two** 16×16-to-16-inch-round transitions. **They are not in D.T. McCall's \$4,600** — that proposal is explicitly *"unit only"* — but **John is supplying them free of charge**, so they cost nothing. Priced here only so the value is on the record.

🌀 **RDP Square to Round Transition Box, 16" × 16" × 16", made in USA — \$59.95 each, on Amazon, in stock. Two of them = \$119.90.**

Cross-checks found the same trip:

- Same RDP line, **18×18×16 = \$75.95 · 20×20×16 = \$89.95 · 14×14×14 = \$49.95** — the size/price curve is consistent, so \$59.95 for the 16×16×16 is not an outlier.
- **Home Depot — Master Flow SQR20X20X16** (one size up): **\$98.24**, and **out of stock** at Hendersonville. *(The \$73.24 on that page is after a \$25 new-cardholder discount, not the shelf price.)* 🟡 **Home Depot carries no 16×16×16 at all** — searched the model number directly, 154 results, not one square-to-round among them.
- **Lowe's and Ferguson both refused to load** — bot-protection interstitial, no page content served.

⚠ **These may still get fabricated rather than bought** — that is how Peters carries his: *"square to round ducting take-offs will be installed on both the return and supply transitions,"* with the metal inside a **\$1,475** ducting-materials line. Fabricated, the material is cheaper and the cost is labour.

	Daikin, bought direct	Peters · Carrier	Goodlettsville · Tempstar
Unit	\$4,600 out the door, tax in — D.T. McCall written proposal 09-21, unit only, no transitions	\$8,520 unit line <i>(\$6,260 of it is unit + pad, itemised)</i>	\$7,960 unit line
16×16 square-to-rounds (×2, supply + return)	\$0 — John is supplying them free of charge. Value \$119.90 (\$59.95 each, RDP	inside his \$1,475	inside the \$7,960 — <i>"new square to rounds on supply and return"</i>

	16×16×16, made in USA, Amazon, in stock) FREE	ducting- materials line	
Pad	\$77.88 — PAVERS. Jeff's decision, 2026-09-21 5:10 PM. Six Pavestone Avant XL 24×24×2 concrete step stones @ \$12.98 (model 11019457), laid 2 wide × 3 deep = 48×72 on compacted gravel CHOSEN	not needed	not needed
Duct scope, twist fix, plenums	still owed — not in the box price	\$2,750	\$1,800
Labour warranty	none — there is no installing contractor	5 yr std; 10 yr +\$500	1 yr std; 10 yr +\$1,594
Commissioning	yours — static pressure, gas pressure, charge check	in writing on the invoice	in writing on the invoice
TVA rebate	unlikely without a participating contractor — verify	–\$300 stated	not stated
10-year cost	not comparable until the duct work and labour are priced	\$11,470	\$11,354

What is now ANSWERED by the 09-21 proposal, and what is still open

1. **Are you an authorized Daikin dealer, and can you sell DP3GM3006031 over the counter?** Their retail site lists no HVAC equipment brands at all, so this is unconfirmed. Ask for the **full model number on the receipt**.
2. **Is the 11th character a 3?** Confirm R-32, not the R-410A . . . 041 version.
3. **What brand is the compressor?** This is the one thing no document answers. Ask them to read the **compressor label on the actual unit**, or pull the R-32 repair-parts manual from their Daikin distributor portal. On the previous R-410A generation the 2.5-ton was a Copeland ZP25K5 **but the 2-ton in the same line was a Rechi** — the brand is not uniform across the line, so it cannot be assumed.
4. **What is the written price, and do they install?** If D.T. McCall sells it **and** sets it, every warranty question collapses — they are a licensed, bonded and insured Tennessee contractor doing HVAC since 1978.

Bottom line.

- **Stainless: yes, and standard** — better than Goodman, whose current sheet does not state a heat-exchanger material at all. The deal breaker is met.
- **Copeland: CONFIRMED.** D.T. McCall put it in writing on their 09-21 proposal. No Daikin document names a compressor brand, so this was only ever answerable by the dealer — and they answered it.
- **The pad is the real cost.** 51 in against 47.5 in — the same finding logged against this engine family on 09-09, now confirmed from Daikin's own dimension table — plus both plenums re-made to 16×16.
- **The warranty survives the counter purchase.** The single best piece of news here, and it corrects an over-stated note in our own file.
- **Slightly worse on the two things you actually feel:** EER2 10.6 against 11.05, and 76 dB against 73.
- **The honest comparison is not \$4,500 against \$11,400.** It is a box with no duct work, no plenums, no pad, no commissioning and no labour warranty, against two finished jobs. Whether that trade is worth it is a labour question, not a hardware question.

Daikin sources, all read this session: SS-DP3GM/DP3UM-R32 spec sheet rev 11/24 · LIMITED WARRANTY PWDPKGETYURG rev 04/2025 · installation manual IM-IOD-3033 · PF-PACKAGED_R32 brochure · Goodman SS-GPGM3/GPUM3-R32 11/24 · Goodman RP-G3322 repair parts (9/2022) · HVACDirect and SkipTheWarehouse listings for GPGM33006031. Carrier/Tempstar rows carried from the 09-17 two-way comparison (product data 48NL-03PD and PGB4-51-02PD). Pad and Nordyne dimensions from ac_unit_and_ductwork_2026-08-31.md.